GATHER & GROW

Sowing Seeds of Inspiration, Growing Stronger Libraries

Join colleagues from across the state for a day of virtual learning and connection! Begin the day with a keynote presentation by Eric Rosswood, "The Ripple Effect: How Small, Intentional Acts of Inclusion Can Have Big, Meaningful Impacts." Eric Rosswood is an award-winning author and commentator on LGBTQ+ issues, including civil rights, parenting, marriage, and politics. The keynote will be followed by three one-hour sessions with three program tracks to choose from:

- **Track 1: Library Administration and Trustee Education**
  - Hiring a Library Director, Legal Issues for Libraries, and the Board President/Library Director Relationship
- **Track 2: Library Programming**
  - Early Literacy Programming, Teen Amazing Race, and Navigating AI Hype
- **Track 3: Advocacy & Access**
  - Accessibility Action Plan, Serving Neurodivergent Patrons, and Library Advocacy

Check out the full schedule on the back of this flyer and find more details on the event website linked below!

FRIDAY, DECEMBER 4, 2026
9:15AM TO 3:00PM

Register & learn more: learning.stls.org



CHAUTAUQUA-CATTARAUGUS LIBRARY SYSTEM · FINGER LAKES LIBRARY SYSTEM · Four County Library System · NORTH COUNTRY LIBRARY SYSTEM · MID-HUDSON LIBRARY SYSTEM · OWWL LIBRARY SYSTEM · STLS · westchester LIBRARY SYSTEM

GATHER & GROW 2026 SCHEDULE

Time	Session	Presenter
9:15-9:30am	Welcome & Introductions	Brian Hildreth, Terry Kirchner
9:30-10:30am	**Keynote**: The Ripple Effect: How Small, Intentional Acts of Inclusion Can Have Big, Meaningful Impacts	Eric Rosswood
10:30-10:40am	*BREAK*	
10:40-11:40am	**Session 1**	
	Track 1: Executive Search Done Well	Dr. Ian Coyle
	Track 2: Play, Explore, Learn: Building Early Literacy Through Station-Based Programs	Kendra Brewer
	Track 3: Your Library Accessibility Action	Katie St. Laurent
11:40am-12:40pm	*LUNCH & Networking Session*	
12:40-1:40pm	**Session 2**	
	Track 1: Legal Issues for Libraries	Stephanie Cole Adams
	Track 2: Ready, Set, Race! Implementing a Teen Amazing Race into Teen Programs	Cherish Inman
	Track 3: Serving Neurodivergent Patrons	Dr. Courtney Tsahalis
1:40-2:00pm	*BREAK with Chair Yoga*	
2:00-3:00pm	**Session 3**	
	Track 1: Exploring the Library Director and Board President Relationship	Panel Presentation
	Track 2: Navigating AI Hype in Small Public Libraries	Hannah Cyrus
	Track 3: Library Advocacy	AnnaLee Dragon & Kerstin Cruger

